

EVERYDAY LIFE

You've probably seen the Colosseum on TV. You may even have visited a place where Romans lived—a town, a villa, or maybe a fort. It's difficult to imagine that jumbles of broken walls were once buildings, but to the Romans, they were homes and places of work. So what was it like to live in a Roman city? What did people do, what did they eat, and what clothes did they wear?

Costume customs

Clothes were usually made from wool or linen. The basic item of clothing worn by absolutely everyone—men, women, and children—was the tunic (*tunica*). This simple, loose garment hung from the shoulders to just below the knees, like a long shirt. It could be worn with or without sleeves and was fastened at the waist by a belt. Tunics were either plain or decorated on the front and back with vertical colored stripes (*clavi*).

Men and women also wore the same types of shoes. Leather sandals and slippers (*socci*) were worn indoors, while boots were worn outdoors. Peasants and slaves wore clogs with hard-wearing wooden soles.



WOMEN WORE EARRINGS AND NECKLACES. THEIR HAIR WAS TIED BACK AND HELD IN PLACE WITH PINS AND RIBBONS.